

The First Test

Sixty-year-old Ken finally decided to **call it quits**. He had been a cat **burglar** for the better part of his life and now he was no longer as **spry** as he once was. He had broken into **innumerable** homes, but had not been caught even once. He came to be called 'Untouchable Ken'.

His teenage son wanted to become a thief and thought he could learn valuable tips from his expert father. The master burglar agreed to teach him the **tricks** of the **trade**.

Few weeks later, Ken said, "Tonight will be a test. Be prepared."

Little before midnight, Ken **slung** his bag containing his burglar's tools over his shoulder and instructed his son to follow him quietly. Ken **zeroed in** on a mansion whose guard was fast asleep. Ken **clambered** over the wall with his son **in tow**. Through a window was open and the duo **crept** inside.

Ken scanned the room and saw a wooden wardrobe. He **deftly** opened it and **motioned** his son to his side.

He **whispered**, "Enter the cupboard and pick out the expensive clothes while I check out the other rooms. Don't make a sound!"



As soon as the teen stepped inside, he **slammed** the door of the wardrobe **shut**. He gathered his tools and slipped out of the house. He **banged** on the front door and **yelled**, "Thief! Thief!"

The guard **woke up** with a start and began **blowing** his **whistle**. The lights came on in the house, but before anyone could see him, Ken disappeared into the night.

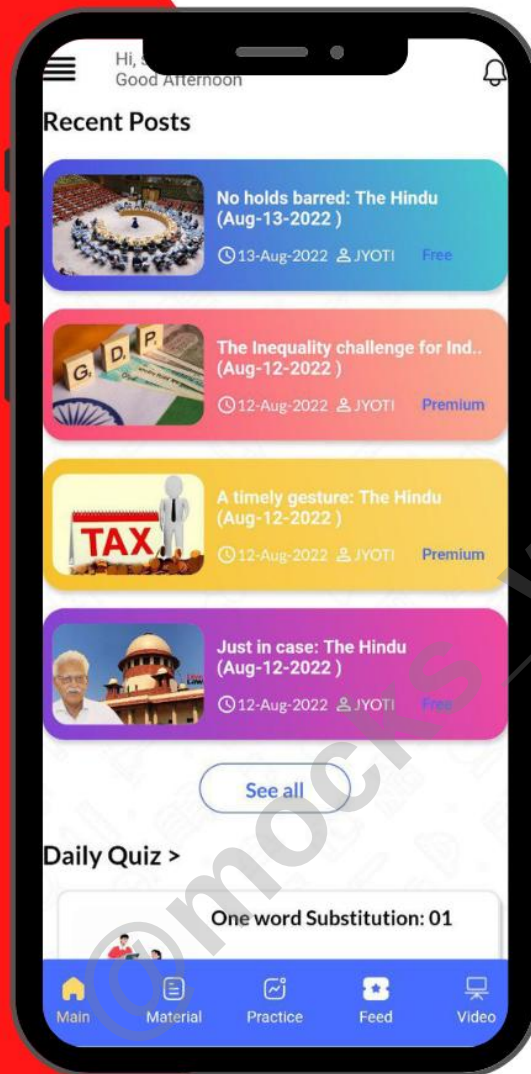
Hours later, Ken's son came home, **exhausted** and angry. "Father!" he **snapped**. "Why did you lock me in? I was so fearful of being caught that I had to use all my **ingenuity** to escape."

The master burglar smiled and said, "Congratulations, son! You have passed your first test."

Vocabulary

1. **Call it quits** (phrase) – stop, retire, give up, pack it in, throw in the towel काम छोड़ देना
2. **Burglar** (noun) – housebreaker, thief, intruder, cat burglar, prowler घरफोड़िया चोर
3. **Spry** (adjective) – agile, nimble, lively, brisk, sprightly चुस्त-दुरुस्त
4. **Innumerable** (adjective) – countless, myriad, numberless, innumerable, uncountable असंख्य
5. **Trick** (noun) – technique, tactic, tip, knack, stratagem ढाँच-पैच
6. **Trade** (noun) – profession, craft, occupation, vocation, line of work पेशा
7. **Sling** (verb) – hoist, heave, toss, drape, shoulder कंधे पर टांगना
8. **Zero in** (phrasal verb) – focus on, target, home in on, fix on, pinpoint निशाना साधना
9. **Clamber** (verb) – scramble, climb, haul oneself up, scale, scramble up हाथ-पैर टेककर चढ़ना
10. **In tow** (phrase) – accompanying, following, along, in company, tagging along साथ-साथ
11. **Creep** (verb) – sneak, tiptoe, slink, sidle, steal (along) दबे पाँव चलना
12. **Deftly** (adverb) – skillfully, adroitly, nimbly, dexterously, expertly कुशलता से
13. **Motion** (verb) – gesture, signal, beckon, wave, indicate इशारा करना
14. **Whisper** (verb) – murmur, mutter, hiss, speak softly, breathe फुसफुसाना
15. **Slam** (verb) – bang, crash, smash, thump, shut forcefully जोर से पटकना
16. **Shut** (verb) – close, seal, fasten, latch, bolt बंद करना
17. **Bang** (on) (verb) – pound, hammer, knock hard, thump, batter जोर-जोर से पीटना
18. **Yell** (verb) – shout, scream, holler, bawl, cry out चिल्लाना
19. **Wake up** (phrasal verb) – rouse, awaken, stir, arouse, get up जगा देना
20. **Blow** (verb) – expel air through pursed lips बजाना
21. **Whistle** (noun) – tooter, pipe, signal whistle, tin whistle, hooter सीटी
22. **Exhaust** (verb) – tire out, weary, drain, enervate, fatigue थका देना
23. **Snap** (verb) – retort, bark, snarl, snap back, speak sharply झिड़कना
24. **Ingenuity** (noun) – cleverness, resourcefulness, inventiveness, creativity, cunning सूझ-बूझ

@mocks_wallah



Learn Vocabulary Through Reading Articles

English Madhyam